

Impact of Technology on Crime

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Technology has had countless transformative impacts on our lives, altered the nature and execution of criminal activity, and the way we prevent crime and justice is delivered. Criminals majorly use social media as a tool to exploit victims whether it be through theft, blackmailing, fraud, or human trafficking. In the modern technological era, digital innovations have the capacity to enhance access to justice, improve the efficiency of court procedures and artificial intelligence offers significant potential for advanced analysis and reduces the workload created by routine of administrative duties. In 2025, reported losses to IC3 exceeded \$20 billion with investment fraud, business email compromise, and tech support scams among the leading causes. The FBI also reduced major losses through Operation level Up, preventing \$500 million in crypto scam losses since 2024.

How technology helps criminals:

One of the biggest impacts of technology on crimes are how easy and accessible it can become with access to technology. Furthermore, with access to newer technology, it's also becoming increasingly harder to detect the criminals that incorporate these faster and smarter methods. According to UNODC, most criminals use online sites and communication sites as a way to commit these crimes, including the recruitment of victims to commit illegal activities. In some cases, it was also reported that victims were forced to livestream explicit and sexual activities to subscribers who had subscribed for money. It's also reported that such sites are also used to gain personal information and data, to then later on, commit crimes such as identity theft or data fraud. By recent analysis of the UNODC, it was discovered that 79 cases of human trafficking involved the use of the internet and technology in across 30 different countries. This further proves that websites and apps have made it easier for criminals to commit these crimes in an organised and professional way, also removing any communication barriers from across borders.

Apps such as TikTok and Instagram are amongst the most common apps exploited as they're mostly used by teenagers, who maybe naive or unaware of such criminals; it's easy for these criminals to manipulate such teens to use them as victims. Traffickers take advantage of the fact that social media is free for everyone and almost everyone has access to it nowadays. It allows them to reach targets even easier now.

Technology hasn't just helped traffickers; it has also made almost every other type of online scam much more common. According to FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center (IC3), cyber frauds took up 85 percent of all the reported losses that occurred in 2025, the complainants amounted to 452,868, and losses totaling upto \$17.6 billion. Furthermore, it's also becoming increasingly easier for criminals to commit more frauds as it's become possible to steal data to make convincing fake profiles, synthetic voices, phishing messages, and other deceptive tools which makes it easier to manipulate victims. IC3 received more than 22,000 complaints from users who reported AI related crimes in 2025, with losses exceeding \$863 million. These developments show that technology has become a key component for criminals too while also increasing the reach, and making it harder to be detected at the same time.

Technology in crime prevention and criminal justice:

Artificial intelligence holds a lot of potential to bring a revolutionary improvement into solving criminal justice matters, both domestically and across borders. Predictive policing is a great example of the impact AI has on administration of justice, by using algorithms that process large quantities of data, an increasing amount of law enforcement bodies have adapted software for analysis of data, identifying connections between various activities, and even in predicting where the next threat will emerge. In addition, other than predictive policing AI can be used in a number of things such as analysis. Social media for example produces a large number of complex data in the electronic format with useful patterns that humans can't identify, but that's where artificial intelligence comes in. Furthermore, AI-backed tools can be used in facial recognition software often used in crime cases and AI can be used to identify or locate events in a specific time or place.

Artificial intelligence is also really impactful when it comes to cross border collaboration in machine translation cases. In addition, it's also extremely relevant in terms of cross-border criminal justice co-operation in terms of automated text summarization systems that help authorities with an enormous amount of information that needs to be processed in a short period of time. Other than artificial intelligence, many jurisdictions have adapted digital case management systems. Main tools used are automated workflows, electronics filing systems, and online document management systems. Streamlining administrative processes, reduce paper work. Not only that, but the digitalization of case management system also helps with collection and analysis of data, helping authorities understand case trends, case processing times, and resource allocation needs. Improving, resource management, policy development and understanding the effectiveness of related interventions. Modern technology allows the use of electronic platforms for managing and compiling statistical data. Case management systems are also greatly efficient for central authorities to adequately understand the growing need for international co-operation, furthermore the use of statistical data can provide more efficient case management monitoring. Automated document processing, as previously mentioned, can be used to extract data and to categorize particular cases reducing the backoffice work such as manual document processing. Such automation can be used to create case information forms that: store, collect and access information in support of authorities.

Conclusion:

Conclusively, technology has not only changed the way crimes are committed but also the way they are prevented, investigated and prosecuted. Many countries have adapted technology to help the central authorities work properly and decrease the number of crimes happening. So, it's high time we enhance international co-operation through the use of technology and these innovative tools. In addition, countries should conduct training sessions for their authorities and forces to understand the use and benefits of technology. As recognized in ECOSOC Resolution 2002/13, crime prevention is not only about reducing crime itself but also about limiting its wider harmful effects on individuals and the entire society. Well-planned crime prevention strategies also contribute to sustainable development, particularly SDG 16 on peace and justice, SDG 11 on safe and resilient cities and SDG 5 on ending violence against women and girls. This shows that effective responses to crime including those supported by technology, have social importance far beyond law enforcement.

alone. Concludingly, countries should develop monitoring systems and understand the risk of malicious use of technology, develop and promote strict ethical standards in the use of technology to protect privacy fairness and human rights.

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